

EVENT

Hurricane / TS Lala – Central Pacific

RESEARCH CUTOFF

Aug 17, 2026 · 08:00 HST

REPORT

Operations & business development

DISTRIBUTION

NorthStar leadership · Executive General Adjusters

— STORM RESPONSE BRIEFING – HAWAIIAN ISLANDS

Lala spared the coastline a landfall. It did not spare the grid, the highways, or Ka'ū.

A four-county assessment of structural damage, high-voltage grid failure, transport isolation, and life-safety response — with the claims outlook and the recovery workload it implies. Every figure carries its source and confidence rating.

PEAK CUSTOMERS OUT

250.9_k

HECO peak · Aug 16, 11:00 — confirmed

TRANSMISSION LINES DOWN

25

16 Hawai'i Island · 9 O'ahu — corroborated

HOMES DAMAGED / DESTROYED

100₊

Southern Big Island — preliminary, Gov. Green

MAX REPORTED RAINFALL

33₊ in

Laupāhoehoe, since Friday — obs windows differ

PEAK REPORTED GUST

140_{mph}

Mauna Kea summit obs — carried 100+ to 140

CONFIRMED STORM DEATHS

0

2 determinations pending — do not attribute

What happened, what it costs, and where the work is.

- + **No landfall, hurricane-grade hit.** Lala peaked as a Category 1 (80 mph, 985 mb) passing about 30 miles south of Ka Lae on Saturday evening, brushed the southern Big Island with its eyewall, and was downgraded to a tropical storm at 2:00 a.m. Sunday. It was a hurricane for roughly 17 hours — all of them next to Hawai'i Island.
- + **Water on Hawai'i Island, wind on O'ahu and Maui.** 33 inches of rain fell at Laupāhoehoe; a flash-flood emergency in Ka'ū swept two homes away (confirmed) and damaged or destroyed 100+ (preliminary, Gov. Green). O'ahu logged 39–66 reported roof-damage incidents and 147 downed trees — a full day after closest approach.
- + **The grid took the structural hit.** HECO peaked at 250,900 customers out — about half its base — with 25 high-voltage transmission lines down; a 42-mile Hāmākua span lost multiple poles. HECO projects days for urban O'ahu and Maui, and **weeks to months** for rural Big Island.
- + **Ka'ū is cut off.** Highway 11 collapsed near Nā'ālehu, 6–8 bridges are damaged or destroyed, and Pāhala — home of the district's only hospital — had no ground access Sunday. The Kona side is the only way in until an emergency bypass opens.
- + **Recovery machinery is moving.** Hilo and Kona airports reopened Sunday; all commercial ports were reopened by Monday. About 100 mainland mutual-aid line workers arrive Tuesday and work Wednesday. Joint preliminary damage assessment is underway; no Stafford Act request had been filed as of Sunday.
- + **Early money signals.** Statewide damage "in the hundreds of millions" and agriculture losses of \$50M+ — both preliminary. The state unlocked a \$100M emergency fund on August 13, before the storm arrived.
- + **No confirmed storm deaths.** One Big Island traffic death is disputed as to storm attribution; one recovered body is under determination. No casualty figure belongs in any client-facing material.

BOTTOM LINE — EXECUTIVE GENERAL ADJUSTERS

Severity sits in Ka'ū, frequency sits on O'ahu. Ka'ū's swept and washed-out homes are flood-causation files inside a simultaneous eyewall wind field — expect wind-versus-water disputes on every partial loss. Only Hawai'i County was hurricane-warned, and most neighbor-island damage accrued Sunday, after the downgrade: hurricane-deductible applicability turns on trigger wording. Power, civil-authority, and ingress/egress interruption claims will outnumber structure claims. The 72-hour mold threshold lands Tuesday–Wednesday.

BOTTOM LINE — NORTHSTAR OPERATIONS

Stage Kona for Ka'ū, Hilo for the windward corridor. Ka'ū movements are convoy-with-road-confirmation, self-sufficient in fuel, water, and comms. Tarping O'ahu's 39–66 reported roof-damage incidents is the highest-leverage 72-hour action. The rural outage plateau creates weeks of temporary-power and drying demand that grid restoration cannot shortcut. The Highway 11 bypass decides whether Ka'ū presents as mitigable water losses or demolition, rebuild, and mold files — track it daily.

Held apart — figures still in conflict at cutoff

Kaua'i outages: ~863 (KIUC, Sun 7 p.m.) vs 36,000+ (Civil Beat, Sun a.m.). O'ahu roofs: 66 (HFD joint briefing) vs 39 (AP/Civil Beat). Ka'u bridges: 6 (mayor's aerial survey) vs 8 (Civil Beat). Carried as ranges or held apart — never averaged.

Seventeen hours as a hurricane. Four counties of consequence.

Tropical Cyclone Lala (CP012026) never made landfall. Terrain did the damage: the eyewall's rain trained onto Mauna Loa's southern slopes while tropical-storm wind fields worked the whole chain for another full day.

80_{mph}

Peak intensity — Category 1

985 mb · Sat Aug 15, ~5–7 p.m. HST · CPHC — confirmed

~30_{mi}

Closest pass, south of Ka Lae

Sat Aug 15, ~5 p.m. HST — eyewall brushed the southern Big Island

17_{hrs}

Total time at hurricane strength

Sat 9 a.m. → Sun 2 a.m. HST — all within ~150 mi of Hawai'i Island

305_{mi W}

Last advisory position

Of Honolulu · Sun 11 p.m., 60 mph — all warnings discontinued · CPHC Adv. 20

Event sequence — HST

- Aug 13**

Advisories begin; state moves first

CPHC opens advisories on Lala. Governor Green signs an emergency proclamation and unlocks a \$100M emergency fund — before the first band arrives.
- Aug 14**

Pre-staging

Hawaiian Electric activates its incident response plan and stages 500+ workers. Hawai'i County issues its own proclamation. USCG port condition Zulu sequence begins Friday evening.
- Aug 15 • 09:00**

Hurricane Lala — Category 1

Hurricane Warning for Hawai'i County; tropical-storm warnings for Maui County, O'ahu, and Kaua'i. That distinction matters to deductibles later.
- Aug 15 • morning-evening**

Windward rivers leave their banks

The Wailuku River in Hilo rises 3.4 → 16.2 ft in 12 hours. Hilo Bayfront floods. Highway 11 begins closing segment by segment, MM 54–69.

Aug 15 • ~17:00

Closest approach — peak intensity

Eyewall passes ~30 mi south of Ka Lae at 80 mph. Mauna Kea summit records a 140-mph gust. Ka'ū takes 3–5 in/hr rain — flash-flood emergency, and two Nā'ālehu homes are confirmed swept away Saturday evening. Big Island outages hit 63,270 by 7 p.m.

Aug 16 • 02:00

Downgrade — rescues through the night

Lala weakens to a tropical storm. National Guard rescues continue in Nā'ālehu and Wai'ōhinu, including two paramedics whose vehicle was taken by the water.

Aug 16 • morning

O'ahu transmission failures; Ka'ū confirmed severed

Statewide outages surge to 197,400 by 7 a.m. as nine O'ahu transmission lines fail. Highway 11's collapse is reported; Pāhala is cut off. Hilo and Kona airports reopen after inspections.

Aug 16 • 11:00

Grid nadir — 250,900 out

HECO's peak: roughly half its customer base, O'ahu alone at 173,900. Mutual aid is requested from mainland utilities.

Aug 16 • evening

Restoration gains; first damage totals

178,400 still out by 7 p.m. — Maui down to 7,000. Governor: 100+ homes damaged or destroyed and damage "in the hundreds of millions" (both preliminary). Bridge tally 6–8 — mayor's aerial survey vs Civil Beat. Shelters drop from 426 to ~100 people. JPDA begins.

Aug 16 • 23:00

All warnings discontinued

CPHC Advisory 20: Lala 305 mi west of Honolulu at 60 mph. Forecast to re-intensify well west of the state midweek — a surf problem now, not a wind problem.

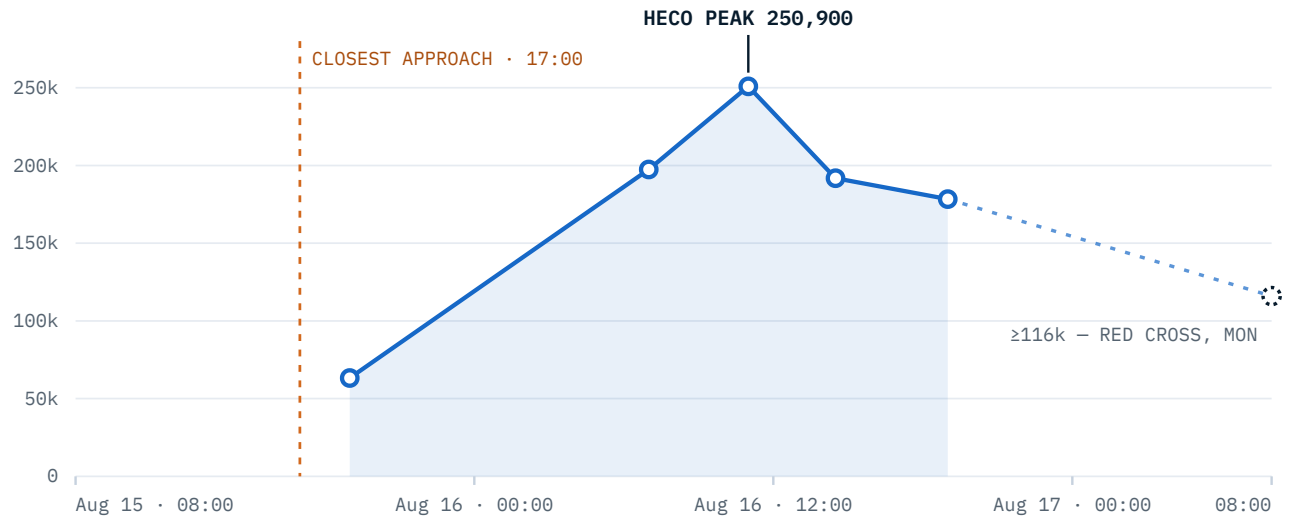
Aug 17 • 08:00

Research cutoff

116,000+ customers still out (Red Cross). ~100 mainland line workers arrive Tuesday, work Wednesday. Highway 11 bypass decision pending. Next full refresh: Aug 18, 08:00 HST.

Customers without power — Hawaiian Electric territories

Aug 15-17 · HECO published snapshots, HST



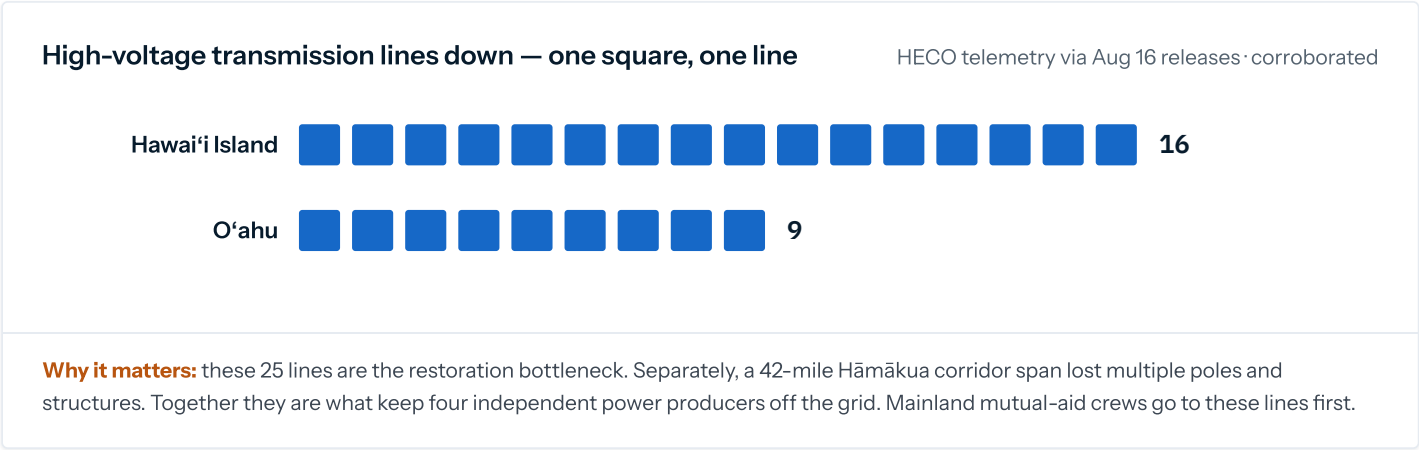
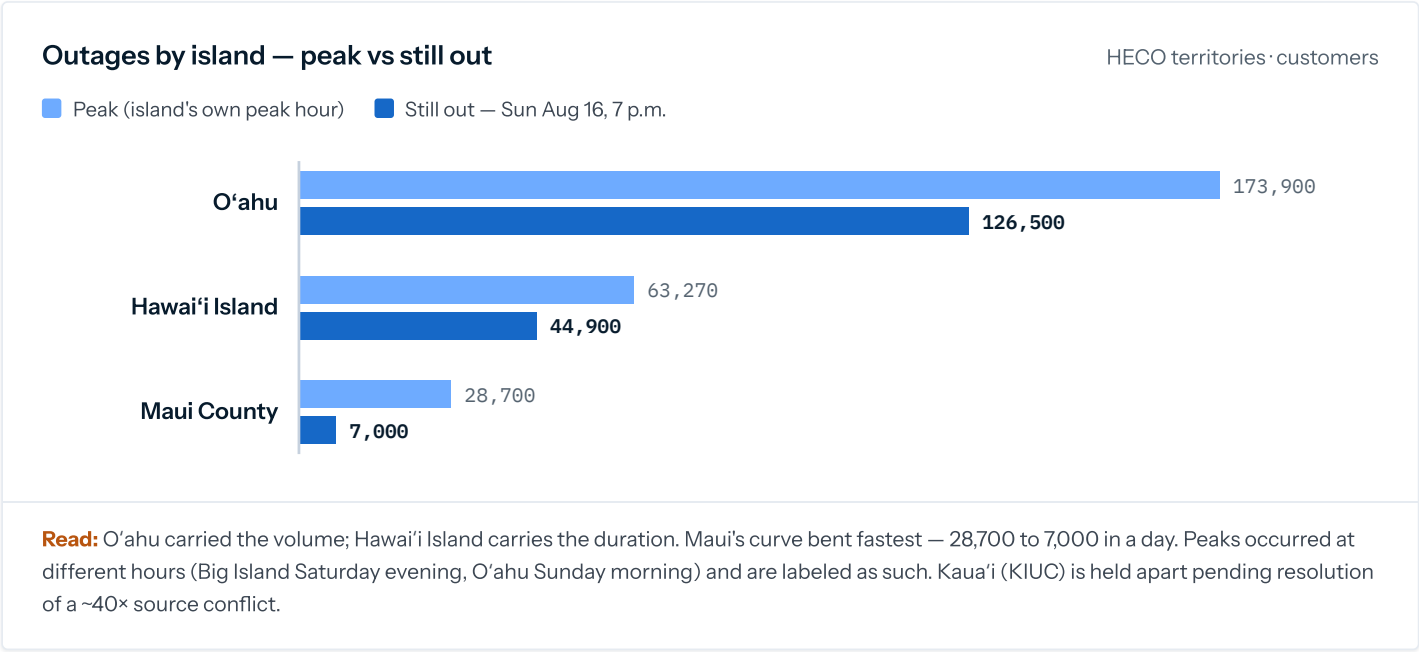
Read: the peak came a full day after closest approach — transmission failures, not the storm's proximity, drove the curve. The Monday point is an American Red Cross cross-check on a different customer universe, shown hollow and never averaged with HECO's series. Kaua'i (KIUC, a separate co-op) is excluded here: its Sunday figures conflict by ~40× between sources (~863 vs 36,000+) and are held apart until KIUC publishes its own tally.

Why rural restoration takes weeks, not days

Damage is vegetation-driven and concentrated in transmission — the backbone between generation and neighborhoods. Sixteen high-voltage lines are down on Hawai'i Island, and a 42-mile Hāmākua span lost multiple poles and structures — which is also what keeps four independent power producers — Puna Geothermal, Hāmākua Energy, Hāwī Renewable, Pakini Nui — disconnected. Distribution crews cannot re-energize what the backbone cannot feed. Section 05 diagrams this.

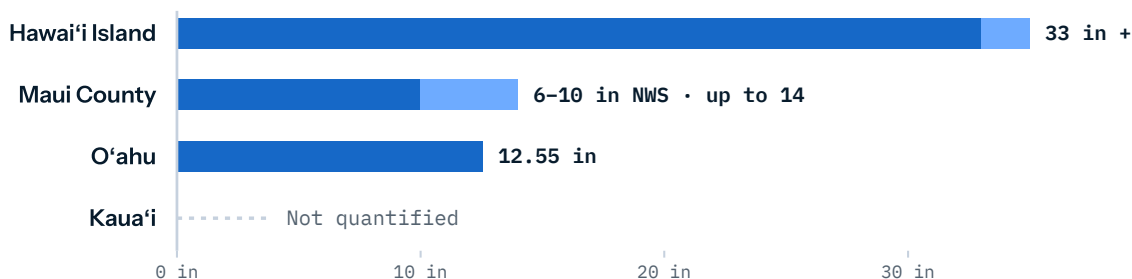
The damage, measured.

Utility telemetry, agency tallies, and gauge observations as of the cutoff. Every figure keeps its timestamp — snapshots from different hours are compared cautiously or not at all.



Maximum reported rainfall by island

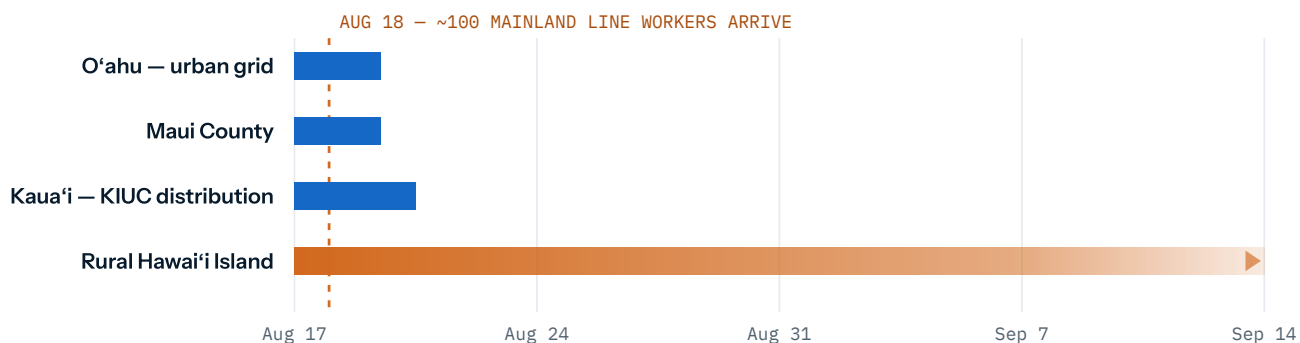
Observation windows differ — do not rank precisely



Caution: figures mix 12-, 24-, and multi-day windows; the NWS post-storm rainfall table was unpublished at cutoff. The scale of the gap is real — the ranking beyond that is provisional. Lighter segment shows the range carried across sources.

Restoration outlook by area

HECO / KIUC statements, Aug 16 • qualitative horizons



The operative sentence: HECO warns of "weeks or even months" for rural Hawai'i Island — Puna, Ka'ū, the Kona districts, South Kohala. That plateau is the demand signal for temporary power, fuel logistics, and mitigation that cannot wait for the grid. Wednesday's mutual-aid work start produces the first credible duration estimates.

Life safety & response volume

59

Ocean rescues — O'ahu, Saturday

Honolulu Ocean Safety; 7,700 preventative actions — synthesis-carried

12_{/4}

Residents rescued / flooded homes

Waiāhole-Waikāne, windward O'ahu • confirmed (synthesis)

147

Downed-tree incidents — O'ahu

HFD, with 29 downed-line and 16 water calls • confirmed

39₋₆₆

Roof-damage incidents — O'ahu

Conflicting official tallies — carried as a range

426→~100

People sheltered, Sat → Sun night

Red Cross; Ka'ū shelters staying open · confirmed

226

National Guard deployed

Including swift-water rescues in Nā'ālehu and Wai'ōhinu · confirmed

6₋₈

Ka'ū bridges damaged or destroyed

Mayor's aerial survey vs Civil Beat — engineering tally pending

30₊

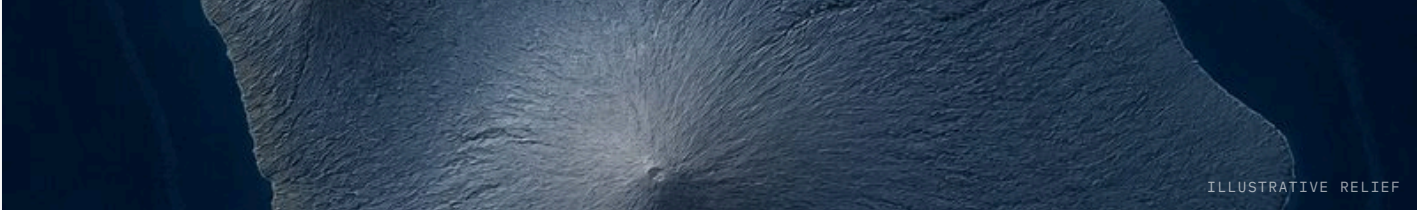
County roads closed — Hawai'i Island

Plus Hwy 11 MM 54–69, Hwy 19, 250, 270 segments · corroborated

Four counties, four different storms.

Hawai'i Island

CATASTROPHIC — KA'Ū



ILLUSTRATIVE RELIEF

63.3k PEAK OUT • SAT 7 P.M.	33 in RAIN • LAUPĀHOEHOE	140 mph GUST • MAUNA KEA
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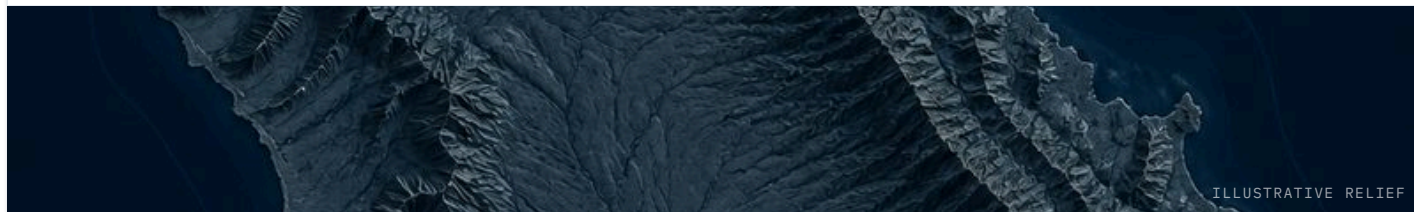
- Ka'ū flash-flood emergency at 3–5 in/hr: 2 homes confirmed swept away in Nā'ālehu on Saturday evening; 100+ damaged or destroyed across the southern districts (preliminary, Gov. Green)
- Highway 11 severed — collapse near Nā'ālehu/Kāwā Flats; 6–8 bridges damaged or destroyed; Pāhala and Ka'ū Hospital without ground access Sunday
- 16 transmission lines down; the 42-mi Hāmākua span lost multiple poles; 4 independent producers disconnected; rural restoration "weeks or even months" (HECO)
- 3 hospitals on backup diesel; 2 Liberty Dialysis centers closed; island-wide "Essential Needs Only" water notice; Nā'ālehu/Wai'ōhinu municipal water offline
- Cemetery washout near Nā'ālehu; ag losses concentrated in Ka'ū coffee and macadamia — statewide ag estimate \$50M+ (preliminary)

CONFIDENCE: CONFIRMED CORE • PRELIMINARY TOTALS

HECO • Gov. Green • Mayor Alameda • NWS

O'ahu

SEVERE — WIND FREQUENCY



173.9k

PEAK OUT · SUN 11 A.M.

39–66

ROOF INCIDENTS

147

TREES DOWN · HFD

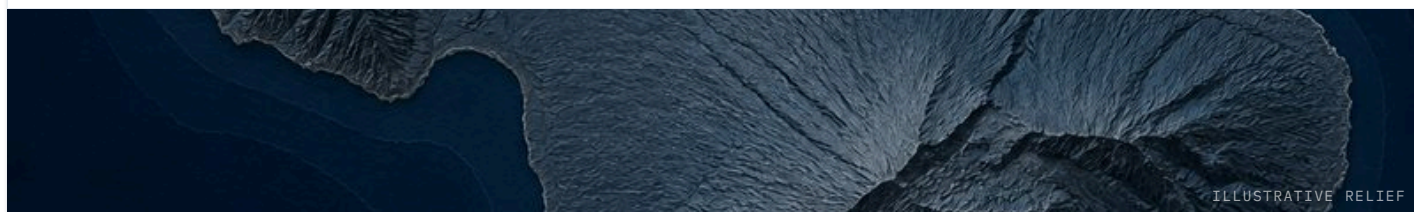
- Nine transmission lines down drove the state's largest urban outage — a full day after closest approach; conservation requested Salt Lake to East Honolulu
- Mānoa Stream record 14-ft flow; H-1 flooding near Makiki and School St; 12 residents rescued from 4 flooded homes in Waiāhole-Waikāne
- Sheraton Princess Kaiulani roof debris partially closed Kalākaua Ave; Mapunapuna commercial district flooded, vehicles stranded on Āhua St
- Tantalus Drive partial collapse; Pali Hwy Kailua-bound lanes closed at last report; BWS 8-inch main break opened a sinkhole in Niu Valley
- City targets normal operations Tuesday; Monday closures for non-essential offices, parks, and licensing

CONFIDENCE: CONFIRMED · ROOF TALLY IN CONFLICT

HFD · HECO · BWS · City & County

Maui County

MODERATE — FAST RECOVERY



28.7k

PEAK OUT

>80 mph

GUSTS · WEST MAUI

6–14 in

RAIN · NWS + WINDWARD OBS

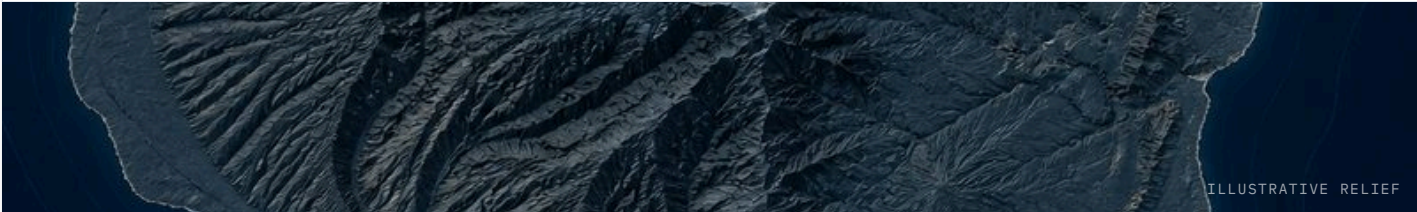
- Mala Ocean Tavern (Lahaina) lost a roof section to wind — the county's largest named commercial loss
- Makawao: eucalyptus onto buildings and poles, businesses damaged including Ohana Island Grindz, simultaneous power and water outage
- North Kihei commercial lots under alluvial mud; Hāna Hwy and Pi'ilani Hwy fragile, local-traffic corridors
- Moloka'i East End access limited by flooding at Kamalō; Lāna'i landfill closed Saturday for unsafe winds
- Fastest restoration curve in the state — 28,700 to ~7,000 out by Sunday 7 p.m.; Kahului port and airport functional throughout

CONFIDENCE: CONFIRMED / CORROBORATED

HECO · MauiNow · Maui County · Civil Beat

Kauaʻi & Niʻihau

ALERT — NORTH SHORE WATCH



~863*

KIUC OUT · SUN 7 P.M.

1

WATER SERVICE AREA DOWN

None

STRUCTURE LOSSES VERIFIED

- *Outage conflict held open: ~863 members (KIUC via county, Sun 7 p.m.) vs 36,000+ (Civil Beat, Sun a.m.) — a ~40× gap; awaiting KIUC's own release
- Kūhiō Hwy closed near Manoa Stream; Hanalei Bridge segment reopened as passable by Sunday evening (county update — supersedes earlier "closed" reports)
- Hāʻena–Wainiha water service out, DOW crews awaiting access; restoration pockets at Kōkeʻe, Mt. Kahili, Kīpū, Wainiha
- DLNR closed Kalalau Trail, Nāpali Coast, Polihale, and all forest reserves; county refuse, landfill, and bus services ran normally Monday
- Niʻihau: zero verified reporting at cutoff — a coverage gap, not an all-clear

CONFIDENCE: CONFIRMED COUNTY DATA · OUTAGE DISPUTED

County of Kauaʻi · KIUC · DLNR

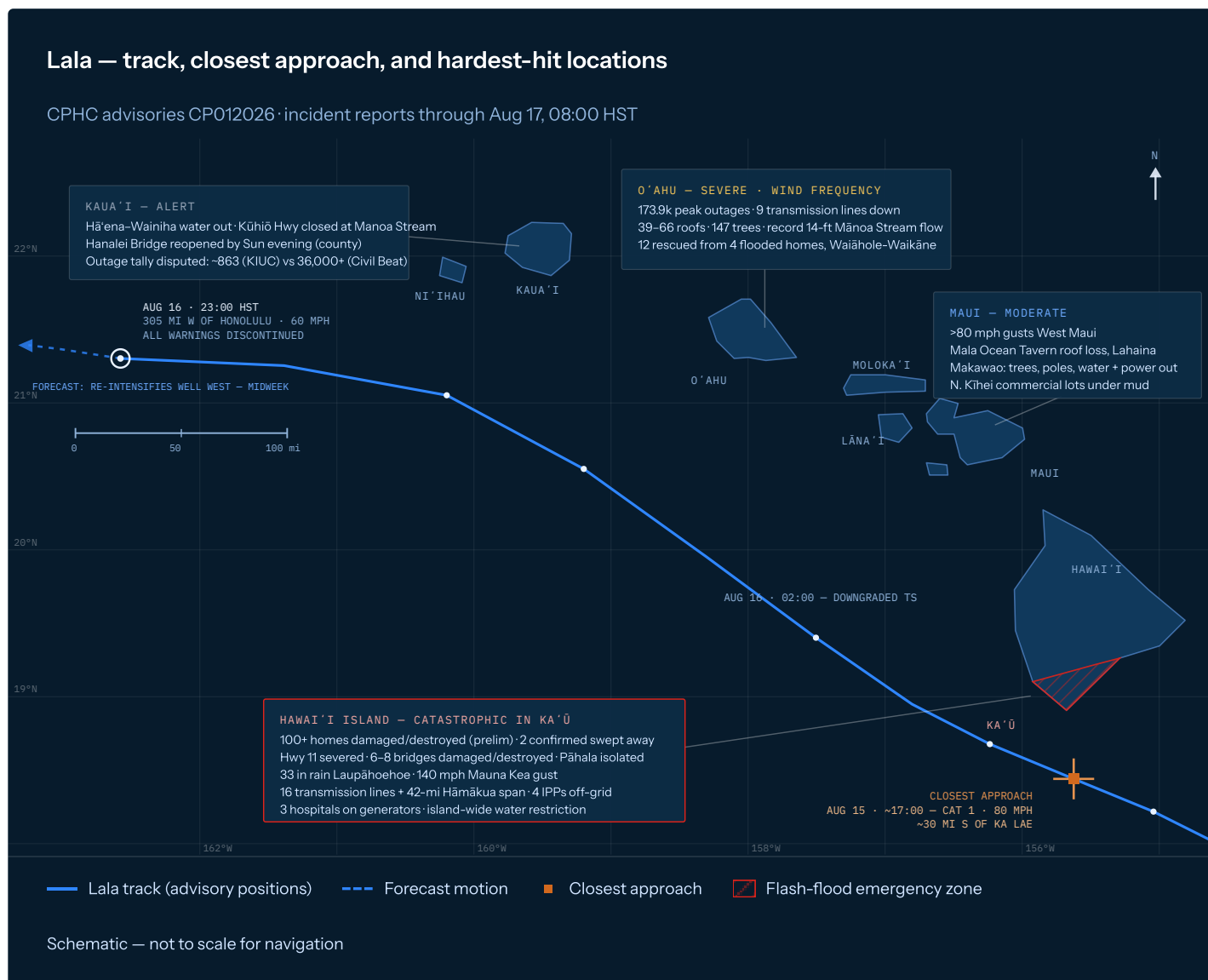
Severity matrix — domain by island

ISLAND	WIND	FLOOD / RAIN	POWER	STRUCTURES	TRANSPORT	WATER SYSTEMS
Hawai'i Island	SEVERE Eyewall brush; 140-mph summit gust (high-elev obs)	CATASTROPHIC 33 in; flash-flood emergency	CATASTROPHIC 16 HV lines; weeks-months rural	CATASTROPHIC 100+ homes prelim; 2 swept confirmed	CATASTROPHIC Hwy 11 severed; 6–8 bridges	SEVERE Island-wide restriction; 2 systems offline
O'ahu	SEVERE 39–66 roofs; 147 trees	MODERATE Record Mānoa flow; valley pockets	SEVERE 173.9k peak; 9 HV lines	MODERATE Roof/debris pattern, no losses of record	MODERATE H-1, Pali, Tantalus, Kalākaua	LIMITED Niu Valley main break
Maui County	SEVERE >80 mph West Maui	MODERATE 6–10 in NWS, up to 14 windward; Kihei mud	MODERATE 28.7k peak, fast recovery	MODERATE Mala Tavern; Makawao businesses	MODERATE Upcountry trees; Hāna fragile	MODERATE Makawao disruption
Kaua'i	LIMITED TS-force; branch strikes	MODERATE Trailing bands; Hanalei Valley ag	DISPUTED ~863 vs 36,000+ — unresolved	LIMITED Minimal direct loss (synthesis)	LIMITED Kūhiō at Manoa Stream	SEVERE Hā'ena–Wainiha out, access-gated
Moloka'i· Lāna'i· Ni'ihau	LIMITED Lāna'i landfill wind closure	MODERATE Kamalō overtopping	LIMITED Moloka'i/Lāna'i in Maui County counts; Ni'ihau no reporting	UNASSESSED Thin reporting	MODERATE East End access limited	UNASSESSED Ni'ihau: no reporting

Severity classes reflect documented impact at cutoff, not final assessment. "Unassessed" marks reporting gaps — treat as unknown, never as unaffected. Island relief tiles are illustrative renderings, not survey imagery.

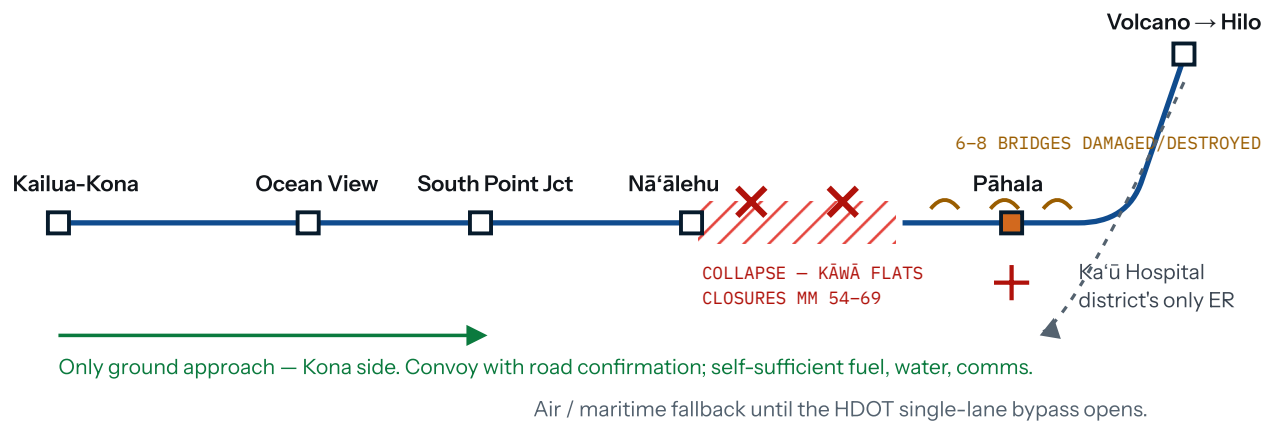
One pass, four counties — mapped.

Schematic plot from CPHC advisory positions and incident reporting. Positions are approximate and not for navigation.



The Ka'ū problem — one road, now severed

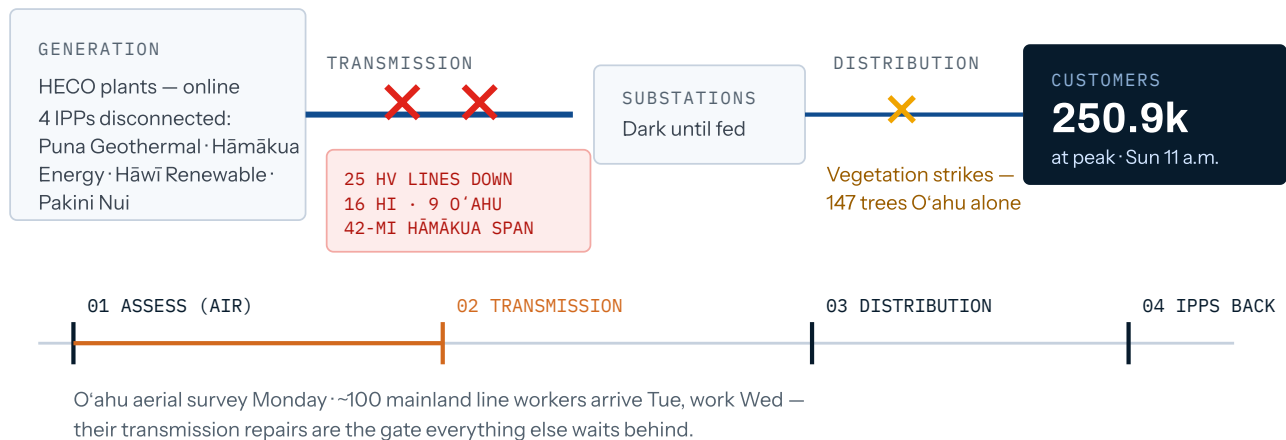
Highway 11 corridor status, Sun Aug 16



Why this one segment matters: everything mitigable in Ka'ū — extraction, drying, tarping, hospital resupply — queues behind this bypass. Every day it stays closed converts water losses into demolition and mold files.

Anatomy of a weeks-long outage

Why rural Hawai'i Island waits while Honolulu relights



Operational consequence: facilities in the rural plateau cannot plan around a restoration date that does not exist yet. Generator fuel cycles, temporary power, and climate control are the bridge — for weeks, not days.

Where the files will come from, and where they will be contested.

No filed-claim counts exist yet — county damage portals opened Aug 16–17 and the joint preliminary damage assessment is underway. What follows are the verified damage facts that will generate claims, the causation map, and the deployment conditions on the ground.

Dominant peril by geography — the causation map

AREA	DOMINANT PERIL	DOCUMENTED BASIS	COVERAGE IMPLICATION
Ka‘ū — Nā‘ālehu, Wai‘ōhinu, Pāhala, Ocean View	WATER + WIND OVERLAP	3–5 in/hr rates, flash-flood emergency; homes swept by flooding; bridges destroyed — while the eyewall sat overhead (51 mph sustained; gusts 71–73 at South Point, county reports above 80, HECO cited ~90)	The concurrent-causation dispute zone. Swept homes point to flood/NFIP; expect wind-vs-water disputes on every partial loss and anti-concurrent-causation disputes on totals. Sequence documentation decides these files.
Hilo / Hāmākua / Laupāhoehoe	WATER + EARTH MOVEMENT	33 in at Laupāhoehoe; Wailuku River 3.4 → 16.2 ft in 12 hrs; active SR-19 landslide	Flood plus landslide/mudflow — exclusion versus NFIP mudflow coverage will be contested on slope properties
West Maui + Upcountry	WIND	Gusts >80 mph West Maui; Mala Ocean Tavern roof; eucalyptus onto buildings and poles in Makawao	Clean wind-causation territory — property policies. North Kīhei mud-over-lots is the water exception
O‘ahu — valleys & flood pockets	WATER	Record 14-ft Mānoa Stream flow; H-1 flooding; 4 flooded homes Waiāhole-Waikāne; Mapunapuna commercial flooding	Flood claims inside an otherwise wind event — verify NFIP penetration; Mapunapuna commercial losses likely flood-coded
O‘ahu — wind belt (Kalihi, Wai‘anae, windward, Waikīkī)	WIND	39–66 roof incidents; 147 trees down; Sheraton Princess Kaiulani debris; 67-mph gust at Kāne‘ohe MCAS	Property-policy wind claims at volume — roof, debris, and tree-impact pattern
Kaua‘i North Shore · Moloka‘i East End	WATER ACCESS	Kūhiō closure at Manoa Stream; Hā‘ena-Wainiha water outage; Kamalō overtopping	Low structural volume — utility, service-interruption, and access issues dominate

The hurricane-deductible question

Lala was a hurricane for roughly **17 hours** — all of it near the Big Island. **Only Hawai'i County carried a Hurricane Warning;** Maui County, O'ahu, and Kaua'i were under tropical-storm warnings. Most neighbor-island damage accrued Sunday, *after* the 2:00 a.m. downgrade — O'ahu's outage peak came a full day after closest approach.

Whether percentage hurricane or named-storm deductibles apply outside Hawai'i County turns on each policy's trigger wording — warning issued, hurricane-force conditions, or named-storm. The warning map by county and the downgrade timestamp above are the evidence base. This report states the facts; it does not adjudicate wording.

Interruption claims will outnumber structure claims

- + **Service interruption:** 250,900 out at peak; weeks-to-months rural Big Island — spoilage and BI in outage-only zones
- + **Civil authority:** USCG port Zulu closures Fri-Sat; Hilo and Kona airports closed, reopened Sunday (HNL never closed); Honolulu's Monday municipal closures — all dated, all documentable
- + **Ingress/egress:** Pāhala businesses have access claims independent of physical damage; ~190-200 Saturday flight cancellations anchor hospitality BI
- + **Contamination:** brown-water advisories and a DOH leptospirosis caution make floodwater Category 3 from day one — scope accordingly

Large-loss watchlist — key named properties in the record

PROPERTY / ASSET	LOCATION	WHAT IS KNOWN	CONFIDENCE
Mala Ocean Tavern	Lahaina, Maui	Roof section torn off by wind — time-sensitive hospitality BI	CONFIRMED · SYNTH
Sheraton Princess Kaiulani	Waikīkī, O'ahu	Falling roof debris; Kalākaua Ave partially closed — only named hotel damage in the record	CONFIRMED · SYNTH
Ka'ū Hospital	Pāhala, Hawai'i	Not damaged — but road-isolated; the district's only hospital; access is the county's top priority	CONFIRMED
3 hospitals (unnamed)	Hawai'i Island	On backup diesel generators; fuel logistics flagged critical — names not public yet	CONFIRMED
Liberty Dialysis ×2	Hilo, Hawai'i	Both centers closed Saturday; damage status unstated	CONFIRMED
4 independent power producers	Hawai'i Island	Puna Geothermal, Hāmākua Energy, Hāwī Renewable, Pakini Nui — off-grid since Sat 4 p.m.; damaged interconnects	CONFIRMED
Nā'ālehu Elementary	Ka'ū, Hawai'i	Classroom floor damage; closed through Thu Aug 20; also serving as shelter	CONFIRMED

PROPERTY / ASSET	LOCATION	WHAT IS KNOWN	CONFIDENCE
Ka'ū High & Pāhala Elementary	Pāhala, Hawai'i	Possibly closed longer; damage detail unpublished	CONFIRMED - CLOSURE
Niu Valley Middle School	O'ahu	Emergency roof repairs by DOE	CONFIRMED
Ohana Island Grindz + Makawao businesses	Makawao, Maui	Building damage from fallen trees; simultaneous power and water outage	CORROBORATED
Highway 11 + 6–8 Ka'ū bridges	Ka'ū, Hawai'i	Collapse near Kāwā Flats; bridges damaged/destroyed per aerial survey; engineering pending — future FEMA PA workstream	CORROBORATED
BWS main, Hawaii Loa St	Niu Valley, O'ahu	8-inch main break opened a sinkhole	CORROBORATED
Mapunapuna commercial district	O'ahu	Minor structural damage, flooding, stranded vehicles on Āhua St — likely flood-coded commercial losses	PRELIMINARY
Miranda's Farms + Ka'ū ag belt	Ka'ū / S. Kona	Coffee and macadamia losses; statewide ag \$50M+ (Farm Bureau) — mostly crop-insurance channels, but farm structures are property claims	PRELIMINARY

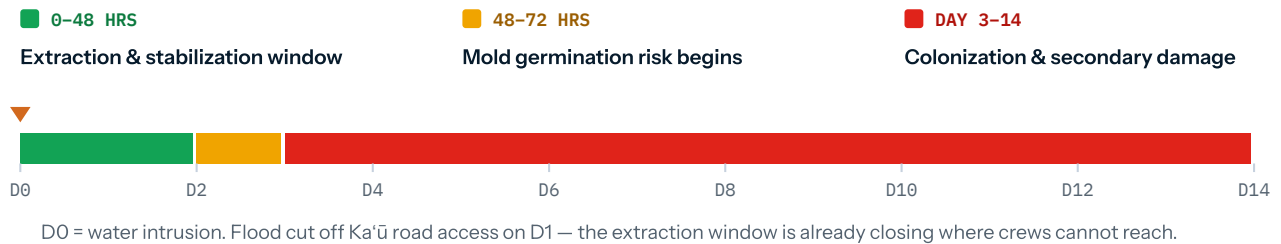
Corpus rule carried forward: nothing in the record assesses any other specific private facility — do not infer a named property's condition from community-level reporting. Mauna Kea summit facilities reported a 140-mph gust with no facility damage reported.

Deployment conditions — CAT logistics

- ✦ **Air:** Hilo, Kona reopened Sunday; HNL never closed. Residual schedule disruption into early week
- ✦ **Sea:** all commercial ports reopened after condition Zulu — barge shipping for vehicles and equipment is viable
- ✦ **Ka'ū:** base operations Kona-side; Pāhala unreachable by road at last report; confirm route status before every movement
- ✦ **Lodging:** no availability data published — but ~100 mainland line workers (Tue), 226 Guard, and agency field teams compress Hilo/Kona rooms. Book early
- ✦ **Power & comms:** assume no grid power in rural Big Island work zones for weeks; carry satellite comms for Ka'ū; potable water and floodwater PPE required
- ✦ **Intake signals:** damage portals live in all four counties; JPDA numbers plausible within 24–48 hrs; watch for the Stafford Act request

The mitigation clock — wet-out was Aug 15–16

Industry-standard water-loss timeline (IICRC-class guidance), applied to this event — not corpus data



Applied to Lala: Kaʻū and Hilo structures wetted Saturday night reach the 72-hour mark **Tuesday night Aug 18**; Oʻahu and Maui Sunday wet-outs reach it **Wednesday Aug 19**. August humidity plus no grid power — no air conditioning, no dehumidification — in exactly the wettest districts compresses the window. Structures in the weeks-long outage plateau cannot passively dry. Tarping Oʻahu's 39–66 reported roof-damage incidents is the highest-leverage 72-hour action; trailing rain lands on every roof still open, and midweek surf from re-intensification works exposed shorelines.

Two cautions for client-facing work

Casualties: no storm-attributed death is officially confirmed — one traffic death is disputed, one recovered body is under determination. Use no casualty figures. **Pre-existing damage:** Kaʻū and rural Hawaiʻi parcels may carry unrepaired March 2026 Kona-low flood damage (separate federal declaration) — a causation and valuation overlap on the same properties.

Where the work is, and what we put against it.

Each row ties a service line to a district and to the specific fact that justifies deploying it. Nothing here is speculative — if the record does not support a deployment, it is not on this table.

DISTRICT	JUSTIFYING FACT	NORTHSTAR SERVICE LINE
Ka'ū — Nā'ālehu, Wai'ōhinu, Pāhala, Ocean View	100+ homes damaged/destroyed (prelim); 2 confirmed swept; flash flooding at 3–5 in/hr; community isolation; cemetery washout	CAT command and emergency response · water mitigation and structural drying on the flooded-not-destroyed inventory · muck-out and debris · contents · total-loss rebuild pipeline · sensitive-scope biohazard support
Ka'ū corridor — Hwy 11 and bridges	Roadway collapse at Kāwā Flats; 6–8 bridges damaged/destroyed; boulder and tree blockage MM 54–69	Heavy debris removal · emergency access support · public-entity reconstruction — bridge and roadway packages under the FEMA PA workstream once declared
Hilo / Hāmākua / Laupāhoehoe	Wailuku River flood; 33-in rainfall; Bayfront flooding; SR-19 active landslide; 42-mi transmission span down	Commercial dry-out on the Bayfront corridor · slope and landslide debris removal · temporary power for facilities inside the outage plateau
Rural outage plateau — Puna, Kona districts, S. Kohala, Ka'ū	HECO's "weeks or even months"; 4 IPPs off-grid; island-wide water restriction; 3 hospitals on generators	Temporary power and fuel logistics — hospital generator support is a named immediate action · temporary climate control to stop secondary mold in closed buildings
O'ahu wind belt — Kalihi, Wai'anae, windward, Waikīkī	39–66 roof incidents; 147 downed trees; Sheraton Princess Kaiulani debris; Niu Valley school roof	Roof tarping and shrink wrap at volume · tree removal from structures · hospitality make-safe and façade debris work · institutional repairs
Urban O'ahu flood pockets — Mānoa, Makiki, Mapunapuna, Waiāhole	Record Mānoa Stream flow; commercial flooding in Mapunapuna; 4 flooded homes; BWS main break and sinkhole	Category 3 water mitigation and structural drying — brown-water and leptospirosis advisories govern scope · commercial dry-out in the industrial belt
Maui — Lahaina, Makawao, N. Kihei	Mala Ocean Tavern roof loss; Makawao tree-struck businesses; commercial lots under alluvial mud	Roof tarping on time-sensitive hospitality BI · tree and debris removal · mud-out and drainage clearing for commercial lots
Kaua'i North Shore	Hā'ena–Wainiha water outage; access-gated KIUC pockets; DOW crews waiting on roads	Temporary water and power support · standby mitigation staged for the moment access opens

Staging — where we sit while the picture firms

Kona is the Ka'ū gateway — the only verified ground approach. **Hilo** (airport and harbor both open) bases windward and transmission-corridor work, with the Hwy 19 (MM 28) slide constraining the northern link. **Kawaihae** serves Kohala by sea. **Kahului** is Maui's working hub. Deconflict laydown with HECO's own mutual-aid staging from Tuesday. Do not stage in Ka'ū flood zones, near saturated slopes, or across unassessed bridges.

Safety posture for field crews

Treat every downed line as energized and hold a 30-foot standoff — tree work near lines is this event's signature injury mechanism. Floodwater is Category 3: leptospirosis caution, no wading, cover cuts, decontaminate. Stay out of stream corridors and gulches 48–72 hours — landslides need no new rain. Dark signals are 4-way stops. Generators run outside, 20 feet from openings. Stop-work authority applies to every person on every site.

— PREMIER RESPONSE

One call mobilizes assessment, mitigation, and reconstruction under a single accountable command.

NorthStar deploys emergency response, water mitigation, temporary power, debris, environmental remediation, and rebuild crews statewide — with the documentation discipline adjusters need on contested-causation files.



NorthStar
We Bring Answers.

What gets done, by whom, checked when.

Consolidated from every recommended action in the record, deduplicated. Status is as of the Aug 17, 08:00 HST cutoff.

ISSUE	LOCATION	STATUS AT CUTOFF	WHY IT MATTERS	ACTION	OWNER / CONFIRM WITH	CHECKPOINT
Hwy 11 severed; 6–8 bridges damaged/destroyed	Ka‘ū	BLOCKED	Sole road lifeline to Ka‘ū communities, hospital, freight	Obtain HDOT/DPW timeline; verify single-lane bypass build; pre-plan Kona-side logistics	Ops lead Hawai‘i Is. · HDOT, County DPW	12 hr, then daily 08:00
Ka‘ū Hospital access + fuel	Pāhala + 3 island hospitals	CRITICAL	Region’s only hospital road-isolated; 3 hospitals on backup diesel	Confirm patient/staff status, medevac contingency; priority fuel-tanker escorts	Health liaison · County CD, DOH, State EOC	Immediate – 6 hr
Rural outages, weeks–months	Puna, Kona districts, S. Kohala, Ka‘ū	DEGRADED	Multi-week life-support, water pumping, comms risk; core mitigation demand signal	Map affected sites; generator and fuel plan; track HECO transmission repair schedule	Utilities coordinator · HECO/HELCO	HECO twice-daily releases
Mutual-aid reception	Statewide; staging TBD	INBOUND TUE	~100 WRMAG line workers arrive Tue, work Wed; lodging and laydown tighten	Complete staging, equipment, and housing plan; deconflict NorthStar laydown with utility staging	Logistics · HECO, WRMAG	By 06:00 Aug 18

ISSUE	LOCATION	STATUS AT CUTOFF	WHY IT MATTERS	ACTION	OWNER / CONFIRM WITH	CHECKPOINT
Water systems	Hawai'i Is. · Nā'ālehu/Wai'ōhinu · Makawao · Hā'ena– Wainiha	RESTRICTED	Potable water and sanitation constraint for crews and clients	Track DWS/DOW notices; monitor bowser deployments; preposition water for partner sites	Logistics · county water depts, Guard	12 hr, then twice daily
Landslide / flash-flood residual	Windward Hawai'i, E. Maui, O'ahu valleys	ACTIVE – HWY 19 MM 28	Hazard persists without new rain on 15–35 in totals	Restrict work near streams and slopes 48–72 hrs; stage slope-stabilization capability	Safety officer · NWS, HDOT engineers	Each NWS cycle
Bridge engineering status	Ka'ū structures	PENDING	Heavy-equipment routing depends on load ratings; high water delaying inspections	Obtain HDOT tallies; no heavy assets across unassessed structures	Ops lead Hawai'i Is. · HDOT engineering	16:00 Aug 17, then daily
Damage-data pipelines	All four counties	PORTALS LIVE	JPDA gateway to federal aid defines recovery scope and claim volume	Track JPDA releases; route partner damage data through official portals	Recovery coordinator · HI-EMA, county EMAs	HI-EMA 08:00 updates

ISSUE	LOCATION	STATUS AT CUTOFF	WHY IT MATTERS	ACTION	OWNER / CONFIRM WITH	CHECKPOINT
Sheltering & displacement	Ka'ū primarily	426 → ~100	Multi-night need if homes uninhabitable; housing-repair scope signal	Coordinate with Red Cross and Vibrant Hawai'i on transition and feeding	Community liaison · Red Cross, county EMAs	Daily shelter census
Casualty communications	Ocean View · Kalihi Stream	DISPUTED / PENDING	Public-messaging accuracy; family sensitivity	Publish no casualty numbers; await medical examiner and police determinations	Comms lead · HPD, Hawai'i PD, ME	Next briefings ~14:00

Operational checkpoints from cutoff

BY 14:00 AUG 17

Ka'ū Hospital access and medevac contingency confirmed.
Hospital generator fuel reserves and tanker escorts verified.
Casualty determination update expected.

BY 18:00 AUG 17

HECO aerial assessments complete on O'ahu and Maui corridors. Hwy 11 bypass decision. Water bowzers checked at Nā'ālehu, Wai'ōhinu, Makawao. County portal tallies begin to firm.

BY 06:00 AUG 18

~100 mainland line workers and equipment arrive; deployment against the 16 Hawai'i Island transmission lines. First JPDA numbers plausible. Full intelligence refresh at 08:00.

BY 06:00 AUG 19

Rural restoration timelines firm after Wednesday's mutual-aid work start. Pāhala access resolved or confirmed long-duration. Lala re-intensification and surf watch. School reopening decisions.

What could still move — and what we simply do not know.

Re-intensification — a surf problem, not a wind problem

Lala is forecast to regain hurricane strength well west of the state by midweek. The operational effect is renewed high surf on west- and south-facing shores through about Aug 19 — coastal facilities, shoreline roads, and any marine staging. Keep crews off exposed shorelines until advisories lift.

Saturated slopes — the dominant post-storm hazard

15–35 inches fell across Big Island catchments — observation windows vary and are not yet comparable. Landslides need no new rain: the Hwy 19 slide is active, Tantalus Drive partially collapsed, and the governor warned that rains of this class bring widespread slides. Watch corridors: windward Big Island, East Maui, O’ahu valleys, Pali Hwy, H-3, Farrington Hwy, Hawai’i Belt Road.

Figures most likely to move

The Ka’ū destroyed-vs-damaged split (JPDA will supersede the 100+ figure). The bridge count (6 vs 8). The O’ahu roof tally (39 vs 66). The KIUC outage scale (~863 vs 36,000+). Casualty determinations. The NWS post-storm rainfall table, which will finally make gauge values comparable.

Coverage gaps are not all-clears

Ni’ihau has zero verified reporting. Moloka’i’s East End, Lāna’i’s interior, the Hāna–Kīpahulu structural picture, and Kona-side damage detail are all thin. No sewage, fuel, or hazmat release was confirmed at cutoff — DOH environmental findings are pending, and absence of evidence is not evidence of absence.

Every plotted figure, in one table.

The values behind each chart, with the detail carried in the on-screen tooltips. Printed and PDF copies lose hover, so the series are reproduced here in full.

A1 · Customers without power — published snapshots

TIME (HST)	CUSTOMERS OUT	ISLAND SPLIT WHERE PUBLISHED	SOURCE & CONFIDENCE
Sat Aug 15 · ~19:00	63,270	Hawai'i Island only — statewide total not published at this hour	HECO via Star-Advertiser · confirmed
Sun Aug 16 · 07:00	197,400	Statewide — O'ahu transmission failures driving the surge	HECO 8 a.m. release, carried in synthesis · confirmed
Sun Aug 16 · 11:00	250,900	Statewide peak — O'ahu alone 173,900; about half of HECO's base	HECO via Star-Advertiser · confirmed
Sun Aug 16 · 14:30	191,800	130,100 O'ahu · 45,900 Hawai'i · 15,800 Maui	HECO noon/4 p.m. releases · confirmed
Sun Aug 16 · 19:00	178,400	126,500 O'ahu · 44,900 Hawai'i · 7,000 Maui	HECO via Star-Advertiser · confirmed
Mon Aug 17	≥116,000	Cross-check on a different customer universe — not comparable to the HECO series	American Red Cross · corroborated

A2 · Outages by island — peak vs still out

ISLAND	PEAK	PEAK HOUR	STILL OUT	NOTE
O'ahu	173,900	Sun Aug 16 · 11:00	126,500	Nine transmission lines lost; conservation requested Salt Lake to East Honolulu
Hawai'i Island	63,270	Sat Aug 15 · 19:00	44,900	Eyewall pass; rural districts face weeks to months
Maui County	28,700	Sun Aug 16	7,000	Fastest recovery curve in the state
Kaua'i (KIUC)	disputed	Sun Aug 16	disputed	~863 (KIUC via county, Sun 7 p.m.) vs 36,000+ (Civil Beat, Sun a.m.) — held apart, never averaged

A3 · Rainfall and wind observations

ISLAND	RAINFALL	BASIS & WINDOW	PEAK WIND
Hawai'i Island	33 in +	Laupāhoehoe, since Friday (corroborated); synthesis carries 30–35 in for high catchments	140 mph summit (100+ carried elsewhere) – high-elevation obs
Maui County	6–14 in	NWS official 6–10 in/24 hr (confirmed); 13–14 in windward slopes by Sat night (Civil Beat, single source)	>80 mph gusts, West Maui
O'ahu	12.55 in	Kawainui Stream gauge, since Friday (corroborated); synthesis carried 8+ in localized totals	67 mph, Kāne'ohe MCAS; 35–50 mph general
Kaua'i	Not quantified	Heavy trailing rainbands Sunday; storm total unpublished at cutoff	Tropical-storm force

Observation windows differ across these figures — 12-hour, 24-hour, and multi-day totals are mixed because the NWS post-storm rainfall table was unpublished at cutoff. Do not rank gauge values against each other until it publishes.

A4 · Grid damage and restoration horizons

ITEM	VALUE	DETAIL
Transmission lines down	25	16 Hawai'i Island · 9 O'ahu — HECO telemetry, corroborated
Hāmākua corridor span	42 mi	Lost multiple poles and structures to wind-toppled trees — reported separately from the line count
Independent power producers off-grid	4	Puna Geothermal · Hāmākua Energy · Hāwī Renewable · Pakini Nui — disconnected Sat ~4 p.m.

ITEM	VALUE	DETAIL
O'ahu urban grid	Days	"Within days" — HECO projection, Aug 16
Maui County	Days	"Within days" — HECO projection, Aug 16
Kaua'i — KIUC pockets	Days	Kōke'e, Mt. Kahili, Kīpū, Wainiha: no restoration Sunday night, work resuming as conditions allow
Rural Hawai'i Island	Weeks–months	Puna, Ka'ū, South and North Kona, South Kohala — "weeks or even months" (HECO, confirmed)
Mainland mutual aid	~100	Western Region Mutual Assistance line workers — arrive Tue Aug 18, begin work Wed Aug 19

How to read this report — and what you may republish.

Confidence labels, as used throughout

- CONFIRMED

Primary agency or utility release, or multiple independent primary sources
- CORROBORATED

Multiple secondary sources agree; primary confirmation pending
- PRELIMINARY

Early official estimate expected to be superseded — the 100+ homes figure is the example
- SINGLE-SOURCE

One outlet only; treat as unverified until matched
- DISPUTED

Sources actively conflict — carried as a range or held apart, never averaged

Figures keep their as-of timestamps. Snapshots from different hours are never merged; conflicting tallies are shown side by side. Where the record is silent, the report says so instead of filling the gap.

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HDOT / Hawai'i County Civil Defense official imagery (road clearing, flood response). Public domain government work. Credit: "Photo courtesy of the Hawai'i Department of Transportation / Hawai'i County Civil Defense"
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ASSET	WHAT IT SHOWS	LOCATION	CREDIT	CLASS	PERMITTED USE
VIS-005	HDOT road-clearing operations — heavy machinery clearing mud and downed trees from a state route · HDOT coverage	State route corridor, Hawai'i Island	Hawai'i Dept. of Transportation	A	Public domain government work — cleared for LinkedIn and client materials with the HDOT / County Civil Defense credit line
VIS-002	Flood debris across Highway 11 — courtesy photo cross-referenced with HDOT closures · story	Nā'ālehu, Hawai'i Island	Sandy Sturbaum / courtesy via Civil Beat	D	Link only — permission required to re-host

ASSET	WHAT IT SHOWS	LOCATION	CREDIT	CLASS	PERMITTED USE
VIS-003	Fallen tree crushing a pickup — geo-located at Pualei Circle near Kapi’olani Park · story	Waikiki, O’ahu	Jessica Terrell / Civil Beat	D	Link only — editorial news rights
VIS-004	Splintered plumeria trees at the law library · story	UH Mānoa campus, O’ahu	Stewart Yerton / Civil Beat	D	Link only — editorial news rights
VIS-006	Boarded and sandbagged storefront — commercial storm readiness · story	North Kihei, Maui	Erin Nolan / Civil Beat	D	Link only — editorial news rights
VIS-001	Toppled tree resting on a residential roof — wire-service still, matched to press metadata · story	Mountain View, Hawai’i Island	Jill K. Briggs / AFP / Getty Images	C	Do not republish — commercial license required; view via the story link

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Emergency response, disaster recovery, environmental remediation, and specialty contracting. Prepared by NorthStar market intelligence for leadership, operations, and Executive General Adjuster partners working the Lala event.

PRIMARY SOURCES

- 1. CPHC / NWS Honolulu — advisories CP012026
- 2. Hawaiian Electric — Aug 14–16 releases
- 3. KIUC & County of Kaua’i updates
- 4. HI-EMA · HDOT · county civil defense
- 5. Office of the Governor · Hawai’i County mayor
- 6. USCG port condition notices · Red Cross

REPORTING REVIEWED

- 1. Honolulu Civil Beat · Star-Advertiser

2. Hawaii News Now · KHON2 · HPR

3. Big Island Now · MauiNow · Kaua'i Now

4. AP · NYT · Guardian · CNN · ABC · NBC

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